

UA funds

UA wants to keep these funds. However, most of the funds were contributed by Eugene Jhong, who is still funding Stuart and Dante. He may be able to pressure UA to support the conference using these funds.

As it stands, Dante (see below) **has indicated that he wants to continue supporting Abi after the July date** and potentially for six more months after that, as noted in the email below. This would effectively correspond to a **\$40k contribution to the conference, which is not currently included in the budget.**

The risk now is that she stays at UA and continues managing the conference from there. First, we may never gain access to the mailing list. Second, reimbursement through IONS would become much more work for us because she would need an intermediary inside IONS. Third, this would significantly increase the risk that we do not retain the conference in the long term.

Abi has indicated that she is ready to move on to IONS. If Abi moves to IONS, it is possible that IONS would get the \$40k as well. A timely decision need to be taken.

Hi Lori,

Thank you for the detailed update and for your patience as Stuart and I reviewed the financial context.

We've discussed the proposal and are in general agreement, with one suggested alternative for your consideration.

To summarize:

- The AABC will assume financial responsibility for UA Foundation account **20-10-3352**, with an expected balance of **\$239,724** at the time of transfer. These funds will be used to support the salaries of **Stuart Hameroff** (Senior Scientist, AABC) and **Abi Montifiore** (currently Conference Director in SBS, transitioning to a position within AABC).
- The funds in account **2370431** will be used to reimburse SBS for general conference expenses. The remaining balance—estimated at **\$39,812**—will then be transferred to AABC.

Alternative proposal: Rather than transferring the remaining funds from 2370431 to AABC, we propose using that balance to continue covering Abi's salary until the account is fully expended. At that point, we would transition her salary support to Foundation account 20-10-3352 under AABC. This approach could streamline the accounting by avoiding a transfer out of 2370431 altogether.

Please let us know which option you prefer.

Thanks again,
Dante



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To: Dante Lauretta, Director Arizona Astrobiology Center and Kim Patten, Acting Chief of Staff and AVP, Research Development Services, Research Innovation and Impact

From: Lori Poloni-Staudinger, Dean College of Social and Behavioral Sciences

Re: Conveyance of Science of Consciousness Conference

Date: 20 May 2025

This memo codifies the conveyance of the Science of Consciousness Conference (hereafter the conference) from The Center for Consciousness Studies in the College of Social and Behavioral Sciences (hereafter SBS) to the Arizona Astrobiology Center (hereafter AABC).

- 1.) AABC will assume responsibility for the conference beginning July 1, 2025.
- 2.) All personnel in SBS associated with the conference will transfer to AABC after all funds in account 2370431 have been expended. SBS will close this account once the fund exhaust date is reached
- 3.) Responsibility for honoring all contracts signed for the conference will transfer to AABC.
- 4.) SBS will transfer UA Foundation account **20-10-3352**, with an expected balance of **\$239,724**, on July 1, 2025 to AABC.
- 5.) SBS will make a \$10,000 sponsorship for the 2026 conference.
- 6.) The conference will waive the registration fees of 20 students during years the conference is held in Tucson for the first 5 years of this agreement.
- 7.) SBS will pay a fee of \$100 students for every student beyond 20 who registers (max of 50 additional students) for the first 5 years of this agreement.

- 8.) SBS and SBS faculty will continue to work in good faith to support the conference and maintain a collaborative relationship, providing sponsorship whenever funds are available.

Lori Poloni-Staudinger
Dean, College of Social and Behavioral
Sciences



Dante Lauretta
Director, Arizona Astrobiology
Center